

Hubs of EXCELLENCE

Breaking new grounds in research and revamping infrastructure, Indian universities have finally come of age. An INDIA TODAY-Nielsen survey reveals.

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI/www.indiatodayimages.com



1 BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY The Halls of Ivy

A RANGE OF OFFBEAT COURSES ATTRACTS STUDENTS TO BHU

Chanting expansion mantra has catapulted the university to new heights

There are very few universities in the country that can boast of having a deep-rooted connect with the country's history, besides being a centre for excellence in academics and extra-curricular activities. The Banaras Hindu University (BHU) in Varanasi belongs precisely to this league.

Established in 1916, BHU was founded by social reformer and free-

dom fighter Madan Mohan Malviya who travelled extensively across the country to gather funds and donations to set up the university. In his endeavours, he was supported by social activist Annie Besant. Once the foundation of the university was laid, studying in BHU became a rage among the students. Such was the euphoria that at the time of third Parliament

around 1962, as many as 137 MPs were BHU alumni. Mahatma Gandhi himself visited the university about 13 times and lived with the students and teachers to guide them on matters related to the freedom struggle and to emphasise on the importance of education. It is no surprise then that the university has produced a number of eminent politicians, scientists, bureaucrats and has